

CS2100 Midterms Cheatsheet

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11. Processor Datapath

MIPS Instruction Execution

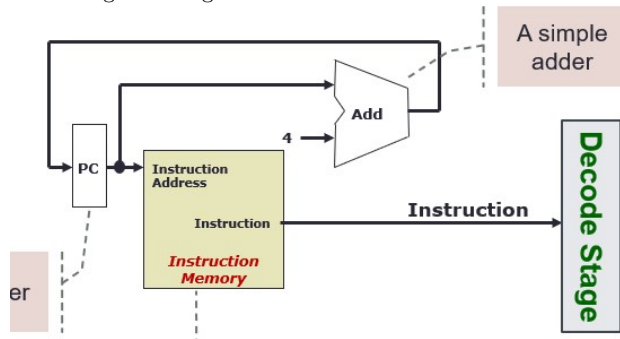
	add \$rd, \$rs, \$rt	lw \$rt, ofst(\$rs)	beq \$rs, \$rt, ofst
Fetch			
Decode	standard	standard	standard
Operand Fetch	- Read [\$rs] as opr1 - Read [\$rt] as opr2	- Read [\$rs] as opr1 - Use ofst as opr2	- Read [\$rs] as opr1 - Read [\$rt] as opr2
Execute	Result = opr1 + opr2	- MemAddr = opr1 + opr2 - Use MemAddr to read from memory	- Taken = (opr1 == opr2)? - Target = (PC+4) + ofst*4
Result Write	Result stored in \$rd	Memory data stored in \$rt	if (Taken) PC = Target

opr = operand MemAddr = address ofst = offset

Fetch Stage

- Fetch the instruction from memory with **Program Counter (PC)**
* PC is a special register
- Increment PC by 4 to get next address
- Output is provided to Decode / Operand Fetch Stage using the Instruction Memory. * address → binary instruction

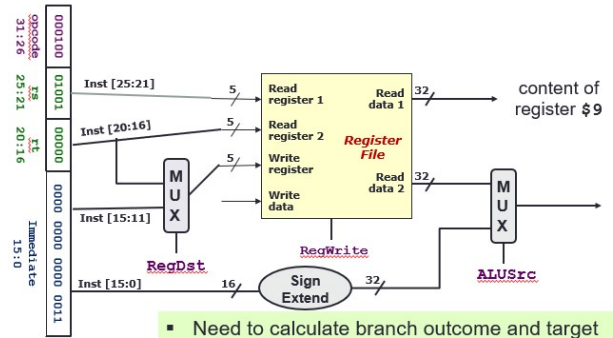
PC is read during first half of clock period and updated at next rising clock edge



Decode / Operand Fetch Stage

Gather data from instruction field:

- Input is the binary instruction from Fetch Stage
- Read opcode to determine instruction format and field lengths
- Fetch data from necessary registers into the Write Register according to RegDst Signal (Rt / Rd)
- Output is the necessary operands to be conducted in ALU Stage



Multiplexer

Selects a specific input from multiple input lines. Consists of:

- Inputs: n lines of same width (32-bits)
- Control: m bits where $n = 2^m$. Specifies which input to choose
- Output: The selected input based on i^{th} input is $control = i$

ALU Stage / Execution Stage

Performs the following operations:

- Arithmetic, Shifting & Logical
 - Memory operation - address calculation
 - Branch operation - register comparison & target address calculation
- Input is the two 32-bits numbers from Decode Stage
2nd Operand is chosen according to ALUSrc signal
 - With the help of 4-bit ALUControl signal, the respective operation is conducted
 - Outputs ALUresult & a 1-bit signal isZero

Branching in ALU

- Identify the branch outcome through isZero to handle equal / not equal
- Calculate Branch address with PC and Offset (Immediate value)
- Output will be used by PCSrc signal

Memory Stage

Mainly for memory read and write instructions **lw** / **sw**. Other instructions remains idle in this stage and instead ALU result passed into Register Write Stage

- Input computation result to be used as Memory Address. Also Write Data for sw (Register Data 2)

- Read or write data on the memory address depending on MemRead/Write Signal
- Output memory address content to Register Write stage (lw)

Register Write Stage

Routes the correct result into the Write Data in register file. Instructions like stores, branches and jumps remains idle in this stage.

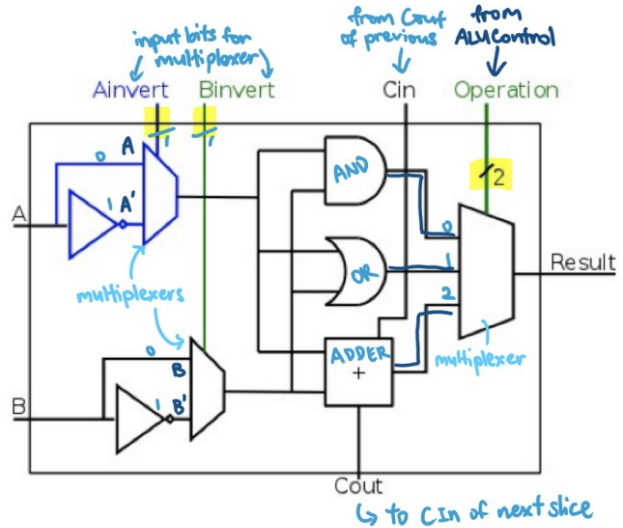
- Input computation result from Memory or ALU, which is specified by MemToReg signal
- Outputs the selected result into the Write Register in the register file

12. Processor Control

Control Signals

- **RegDst** - (@Decode/OperandFetch) Selects the destination of WriteRegister in register file
 - 0/1: WriteRegister = Ins[20:16] (rt) / Inst[15:11] (rd / immediate)
- **RegWrite** - (@Decode/OperandFetch) Indicates if writing on WriteRegister is enabled
 - 0/1: No register write / WD write to WR
- **ALUSrc** - (@ALU) Determines the 2nd ALU input
 - 0/1: Read Data 2 / SignExtend(Inst15:0) (Sign extended Immediate)
- **ALUcontrol** - (@ALU) Determines the type of operation to execute
 - 0000: AND
 - 0001: OR
 - 0010: add
 - 0110: subtract
 - 0111: slt
 - 1100: NOR
- **MemRead** - (@Memory) Indicates if read from memory using Address returned by ALU
 - 0/1: No read / Reads memory with Address returned by ALU
- **MemWrite** - (@Memory) Indicates if write to memory using RD2 of Register File
 - 0/1: No memory write / Writes RD2 into the memory in Address returned by ALU
- **MemToReg** - (@RegWrite) Indicates which one to write back into WriteData in register file
 - 0/1: WriteData = ALU result / Memory read data
- **PCSrc** - (@ALU) Indicates whether to take branch address or not
 - 0/1: $PC = PC + 4$ / $PC = \text{SignExt}(\text{Inst}[15 : 0]) \ll 2 + (PC + 4)$
 - PCSrc = isBranch AND isZero

ALU



ALU operation controlled by 2-bit ALUControl

* Note: operation is determined by the last 2-bits *
Subtraction has $C_{in} = 1$ for bit-0

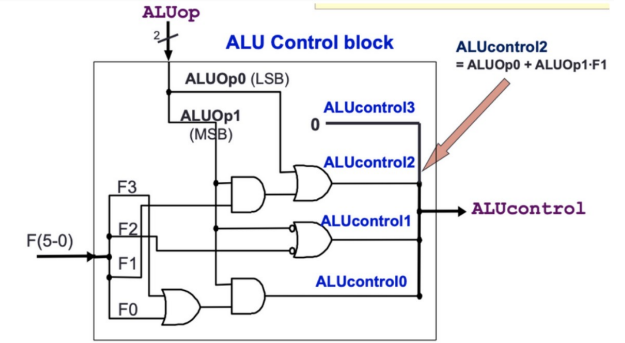
Multilevel Decoding

Used to generate the ALUcontrol signal. (*Simpler and more efficient design than Brute Force approach*)

1. Generate a 2-bit ALUop signal from opcode
2. Use ALUop and Function code (for R-type) to generate 4-bit ALUcontrol signal

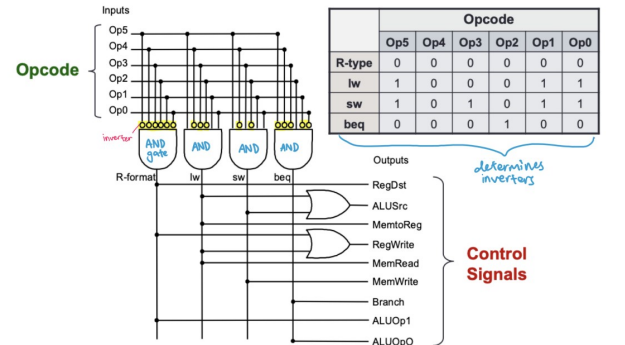
Opcode	ALUpop	Instruction Operation	Function field	ALU action	ALU control
lw	00	load word	X	add	0010
sw	00	store word	X	add	0010
beq	01	branch equal	X	subtract	0110
R-type	10	add	10 0000	add	0010
R-type	10	subtract	10 0010	subtract	0110
R-type	10	AND	10 0100	AND	0000
R-type	10	OR	10 0101	OR	0001
R-type	10	set on less than	10 1010	set on less than	0111

Generation of 2-bit **ALUpop** signal will be discussed later



ALU Control Block

Control Combinational Circuit



Instruction Execution

How the implementation of fetch, decode, memory, write, etc. are actually done

Mainly three things:

1. Read contents from register / memory
2. Perform some form of computation
3. Write results to register / memory

Single Cycle Execution

All performed within a clock period.

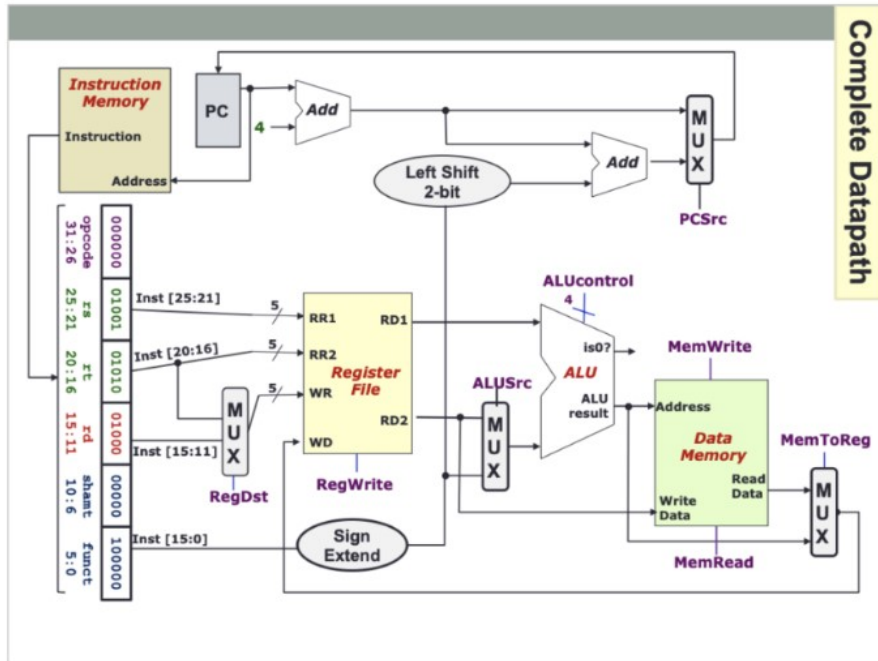
disadvantage: all instructions will take the same time as the lowest one.

Multi Cycle Execution

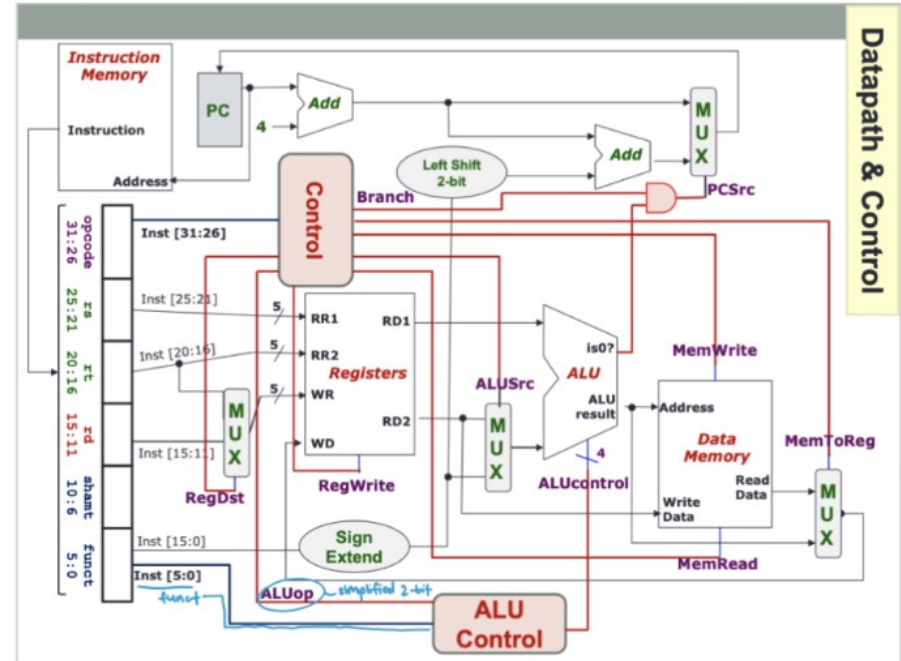
break up instructions into execution steps (Fetch, Decode, ALU Operation, Mem read/write, Register Write). Each execution is one clock cycle. **disadvantage:** time taken depends on instructions and may not necessarily be faster.

Datapath & Control Diagrams

▼ datapath



▼ datapath & control



	RegDst	ALUSrc	MemTo Reg	Reg Write	Mem Read	Mem Write	Branch	ALUop	
								op1	op0
R-type	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0
lw	0	1	1	1	1	0	0	0	0
sw	X <i>writing to address (NOT regdest)</i>	1	X	0	0	1	0	0	0
beq	X	0	X	0	0	0	1	0	1

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